



IN BRIEF

STEPS TO FREEDOM

Women's contributions to decolonization were significant, both in destabilizing the hierarchies of power at the heart of colonial rule, and in postcolonial nation building.

1900

- **1913** Kenyan Mnyazi wa Menza leads the Giriama people against British Colonial Administration.
- **1920-1922** Women in India participate as organizers of the Non-Cooperation Movement led by Mahatma Gandhi.
- **1925** Sarojini Naidu is elected president of the Indian National Congress, the first Indian woman to hold the post.
- **1927** The All India Women's Conference nongovernmental organization is founded to improve women's education and social welfare.
- **1930** Women are mass participants in Gandhi's Civil Disobedience Movement against the Raj.
- **1942** Kasturba Gandhi is imprisoned for her involvement with the Quit India Movement. She dies in a detention camp two years later.
- **1945** World War II ends; decolonization begins.
- **1947** Indian Independence leads to the Partition of India and the formation of Pakistan.
- **1951** The Sierra Leone Women's Movement forms, and over the next decade it plays a fundamental role in supporting the nationalist movement and incorporating women into politics.
- **1952-1960** Women play a significant part in the Mau Mau Uprising in British Kenya, taking on military, civilian, and activist roles.
- **1954** Bibi Titi Mohamed cofounds the Tanganyika African National Union nationalist party. She forms the women's wing, Umoja wa Wanawake wa Tanzania, which empowers women across the country.
- **1958** Indian independence activist Aruna Asaf Ali becomes Delhi's first mayor.
- **1963** Kenya gains independence.
- **1997** The British Empire officially ends with a ceremony in Hong Kong to mark the handover of sovereignty to the People's Republic of China.

◀ **WOMEN SHOUT SLOGANS DURING A QUIT INDIA MOVEMENT DEMONSTRATION IN BOMBAY IN 1942.**

